

*Commissioned by the Myers Park United Methodist Women's Choir,
Charlotte, North Carolina, in honor of Doris Edwards and Cissy Shull*

The Hands That First Held Mary's Child

For SATB Choir, Piano and optional Cello ***

lyrics by **Thomas Troeger**

music by **Dan Forrest**

Thomas Troeger

DAN FORREST

Slowly, with wonder ♩ = ca. 76

The musical score is written for SATB choir, piano, and optional cello. It begins with a tempo marking of 'Slowly, with wonder' and a quarter note equal to approximately 76 beats per minute. The score is in 4/4 time. The cello part (marked 'CELLO') starts with a *pp* dynamic and a 'mysteriously' instruction. The piano part (marked 'PIANO') also starts with a *pp* dynamic and a 'mysteriously' instruction. The piano part includes a first ending marked '1' and a second ending marked '2'. The vocal parts (SATB) enter with a *mp* dynamic and a 'semplice e espressivo' instruction. The lyrics 'The hands that first held Mary's child were' are written under the vocal parts. The score includes measures 1 through 6, with measure numbers 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6 indicated below the piano part.

* Cello part (BP1928A) is available for purchase.

** Full score and parts for flute, oboe, horn in F, harp, solo cello and string orchestra (BP1928B) are available for purchase.

Text: "The Hands That First Held Mary's Child" by Thomas Troeger © Oxford University Press, Inc., 1986.

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hard from work - ing wood. From boards they sawed and

7 8 9

This system contains measures 7, 8, and 9. It features a vocal line and a piano accompaniment. Measure 7 has a vocal note on 'hard' and piano chords. Measure 8 has a vocal note on 'wood.' and piano chords. Measure 9 has a vocal note on 'From' and piano chords. The piano part includes a bass line with a triplet in measure 7 and various chords in measures 8 and 9.

planed and filed and splin - ters they with - stood. This—

Cello

10 11 12

This system contains measures 10, 11, and 12. It includes a vocal line, a piano accompaniment, and a cello part. Measure 10 has a vocal note on 'planed' and piano chords. Measure 11 has a vocal note on 'splin -' and piano chords. Measure 12 has a vocal note on 'stood.' and piano chords. The piano part includes a bass line with a triplet in measure 10 and various chords in measures 11 and 12. The cello part is a single line with a note in measure 12.

day they gripped no tool of steel, they drove no i - ron

mf *legato*

13 14 15

This system contains measures 13, 14, and 15. It features a vocal line and a piano accompaniment. Measure 13 has a vocal note on 'day' and piano chords. Measure 14 has a vocal note on 'gripped' and piano chords. Measure 15 has a vocal note on 'no' and piano chords. The piano part includes a bass line with a triplet in measure 13 and various chords in measures 14 and 15. The vocal line includes a triplet in measure 13 and a note in measure 15.

Musical score for a vocal and piano piece, page 3. The score includes vocal lines and piano accompaniment across measures 16 to 24. Dynamics include *f*, *p*, *poco rit.*, *a tempo*, and *mf*. The lyrics are: "nail, but cradled from the head to heel our Lord, new-born and frail."

Measures 16-18: Vocal line (treble clef) with lyrics "nail, but cradled from the head to heel". Dynamics: *f*. Piano accompaniment (grand staff) with measures 16, 17, and 18.

Measures 19-21: Vocal line (treble clef) with lyrics "our Lord, new-born and frail." Dynamics: *p*, *poco rit.*, *a tempo*. Piano accompaniment (grand staff) with measures 19, 20, and 21.

Measures 22-24: Piano accompaniment (grand staff) with measures 22, 23, and 24. Dynamics: *mf*.

TB unis.

mp gently, with awe

When Jo - seph mar - veled at the size of

mp *espressivo*

25 26 27

that small breath - ing frame, _____ and gazed up - on those

28 29 30

bright new eyes and spoke the in - fant's name, _____ the ____

mf

31 32 33

S p
A
Ah (or Oo)
TB unis.

an - gel's words he once had dreamed poured down from heav - en's

mf

mf leggiero

34 35 36 (b)

mp
Ah (or Oo)
mp unis.

height, and like the host of stars that beamed blessed

37 38 39 40

p

Ah (or Oo) _____

earth with wel-come light.

p *mp*

8va *mf*

mp *p*

41 42 43

rit. *espressivo mf* *a tempo*

"This_ child shall be Em - man - u - el, not

espressivo mf *a tempo*

rit. *a tempo* (Notes within the brackets are optional)

mp *espressivo*

mf *rit.* *a tempo*

44 45 46 47

God up - on the throne, but God with us, Em -

(Play)

(Cue-sized notes are optional)
mp

48 49 50

man - u - el, as close as blood and bone." The- ti - ny form in

51 52 53 54

Jo - seph's palms con - firmed what he had heard, and

55 56 57

f from his heart rose hymns and psalms *mp* for heav-en's hu - man

f *mp*

f *mp*

f (Play) *mp*

58 59 60 61

word.

mf with intensity

mf

f with intensity

62 63 64 65

S *f*

A *f* with intensity

Ah

The- tools that Jo - seph

TB *f* with intensity

f legato

66 67 68 69

laid a-side a mob would lat - er lift and

use with an - ger, fear, and pride to cru - ci - fy God's

70 Red. 71 Red. 72 Red.

73 Red. 74 75

simile

(rejoin section)

gift. ——— Let — us, O Lord, not on — ly hold the

76 77 78

child who's born to — day, but — charged with faith may

79 80 81



rit. *unis. p slower, mysteriously* *a tempo*

we be bold _____ to fol - low in His way. _____

rit. *unis. p slower, mysteriously* *a tempo*

rit. *a tempo*

rit. *p slower, mysteriously* *mp* *pp*

82 83 84 85

mysteriously *p* *rit.* *p*

(8va) *rit.* *p*

86 87 88 89